

Head and Spinal Cord Injured Waiver Policy and Procedures

Referral for Level of Care

Community Long Term Care is responsible for initial (Pre-Admission Screening) nursing facility level of care (LOC) determinations for the Head and Spinal Cord Injured (HASCI) Waiver operated by The South Carolina Department of Disabilities and Special Needs (DDSN). A CLTC Nurse Consultant (HASCI Specialist) has been designated in each Area Office as the person that will facilitate level of care determinations. The HASCI Specialist is the liaison between the CLTC Central Office and the Area Office Staff, and will make recommendations, provide training and assist other office staff on policy and procedures regarding the HASCI Waiver

DDSN has established intake criteria for HASCI Waiver Applicants. Once the Applicant is determined by DDSN to meet the target population for the HASCI Waiver and has been assigned a waiver slot, the Applicant will be referred to CLTC for a level of care determination.

1. DDSN will make all requests for Nursing Facility level of care determinations for HASCI Waiver through Community Long Term Care Centralized Intake. These referrals must be made electronically using the following website:

https://phoenix.scdhhs.gov/cltc_referrals/new

Following electronic referral submission:

- Information is entered into a secure website;
 - CLTC Centralized Intake Team will have immediate access to the referral;
 - The referral will be processed and transferred to the appropriate CLTC Area Office;
 - A referral confirmation number will be provided and may be utilized to monitor the status of the referral.
2. As part of the electronic referral, DDSN Case Managers must attach the supporting documents listed below:
 - South Carolina Long Term Care Consent Form (SCDHHS Form 121) signed by the applicant or primary contact;

- DDSN/CLTC Transmittal Form for Nursing Facility Level of Care (HASCI Form 7) with the top section completed;
3. CLTC will conduct a home visit, complete the assessment and render a level of care determination within fifteen (15) business days of receipt of the case assignment. The level of care must be team staffed with another CLTC Nurse Consultant.
 4. If the HASCI applicant is hospitalized at the time of the level of care request, the level of care is tentative and must be finalized upon discharge. If the discharge is within 180 days of the tentative level of care, a telephone update may be completed. If it appears the applicant does not meet level of care, then a visit must be completed prior to the final level of care determination. If the discharge is greater than 180 days, another visit must be made for the final level of care determination.
 5. CLTC will forward the level of care determination to DDSN via HASCI Waiver Transmittal Form, completing the bottom portion of the form indicating the level of care date and expiration date. A copy of the completed Form 1718 and any pertinent narrative notes should be attached. This information must be sent to DDSN within 5 business days of completion.
 6. This level of care determination is valid for 30 calendar days. Note: Months that have 31 days should be monitored closely.
 7. DDSN is responsible for notifying the applicant of the level of care decision.
 8. CLTC will close the HASCI application in Phoenix as “entered HASCI Waiver”. If the applicant does not meet level of care, the case should be closed as “Medically Ineligible”.
 9. If the Applicant has not entered HASCI within 30 days of the assessment, DDSN will request a level of care update via the HASCI Transmittal Form and a referral submitted electronically. CLTC will conduct an update via home visit or telephone assessment within fourteen (14) days of the receipt of the referral. The level of care must be team staffed with another CLTC Nurse Consultant within three (3) business days.
 10. Note: The update may be completed by telephone if the request is within 180 calendar days of the original assessment. A face-to-face visit must be made if it appears that the applicant does not meet level of care, regardless of the time frame.

11. This re-determination of level of care must be team staffed with another CLTC Nurse Consultant. CLTC will inform DDSN of the level of care re-determination via the Transmittal Form.
12. If the applicant is transferring to HASCI from a CLTC Waiver, the CLTC Nurse Consultant may complete the assessment and level of care via a telephone assessment or face-to-face assessment.

CLTC Referrals to the HASCI Waiver

CLTC Participants may be referred to HASCI Waiver for HASCI services. Participant referrals to the HASCI Waiver should be made by calling the DDSN Eligibility Division at 1-800-289-7012.

CLTC Waiver Participants Transitioning to HASCI Waiver

CLTC Participants may choose to terminate CLTC waiver participation in order to enroll in the HASCI Waiver. See section 10.21.10 for transfer to/from another waiver.

HASCI Level of Care Process

- 1) Individual is referred to DDSN for possible enrollment in the HASCI Waiver
- 2) DDSN determines if the individual meets the target population criteria
- 3) If the individual meets the target population criteria, they are assigned to a case manager who then creates a referral in Phoenix for Long Term Living (LTL) to perform the level of care.
- 4) LTL Nurse performs the level of care. An individual can meet the HASCI-Int by having at least 2 intermediate services.

Nursing Facility Level of Care			
	Number of Functional Deficits	Number of Intermediate Services	Number of Skilled Deficits
Current Level of Care			
Intermediate	2		
Intermediate	1	1	
Skilled	1		1
Skilled	1 Totally dependent in all ADLs		
Changed Level of Care			
Intermediate	2		
Intermediate	1	1	
Skilled	1		1
Skilled	1 Totally dependent in all ADLs		
HASCI-Int		2	

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